

[CLIENT]

PREPARED FEB 2026

[FOR APPROVAL]

Ocean Lodge Hotel

801 Philadelphia Ave, Ocean City, MD 21842

[01]

WHERE THINGS STAND

Ocean Lodge sits at **2.8★ across 343 Google reviews** with zero owner responses on record. Most travelers filter hotels below 3.5 stars — which means the property is invisible to the majority of guests before they ever read a single review. Competing properties on the boardwalk average 4.3–4.5 stars.

At the same time, the Ocean Lodge brand has real strengths worth building on: **three distinct properties under one roof** — North, South, and Mallard Apartments — two blocks from the boardwalk, kitchen amenities, and a loyal repeat-guest base that isn't being captured or nurtured. The gap between where this brand is and where it could be is an opportunity.

This proposal covers everything we'll build together: reputation recovery, a new website, email automation, a content engine, and a full ad campaign — the complete digital infrastructure for a competitive independent hotel in Ocean City.

[02]

WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

01

Google Business Profile Overhaul

SETUP + ONGOING

Your Google profile is the first thing a potential guest sees. Right now it's incomplete and silent. We rebuild it from the ground up and keep it active.

- 25–30 owner-uploaded photos integrated from the professional shoot (exterior, rooms, amenities, boardwalk proximity)
- Property description built around your strongest assets: 2 blocks from the boardwalk, kitchen amenities, value pricing, direct booking advantage
- All amenity tags, hours, policies, direct booking link confirmed and accurate
- Q&A section seeded with common guest questions
- Review responses — every review from the past 12 months responded to, plus all new reviews on an ongoing basis. Drafted by us, approved by you before posting.

On review responses: We go back one full year — recent enough to matter, targeted enough to look human. All new reviews get a response within 48 hours on an ongoing basis. Responses are written individually; no templates.

02 Professional Photography

ONE-TIME

Ocean Lodge currently has zero owner-uploaded photos on Google. Travelers make booking decisions on visuals first. A single professional shoot produces assets that work across every channel — Google, the new website, OTA listings, Instagram — for years.

- Full property shoot: exterior, lobby, room types (North + South + Mallard), amenities, parking, views
- Boardwalk and location context shots — lean into the 2-block proximity advantage
- Lifestyle shots for social and ad creative
- Delivered as an organized asset library ready to deploy across all channels

03 New Website

SETUP + ONGOING

A fresh, standalone website for the Ocean Lodge brand — minimal, beach-kitschy cozy, nothing like the generic OC hotel template. Built for direct bookings, optimized for Google and AI search, and structured to carry the full brand family.

- ➔ **Brand architecture:** Ocean Lodge North, Ocean Lodge South, and Mallard Apartments nested under one domain with distinct pages — plus a "sister property" link to Surf Inn Suites
- ➔ **Direct booking:** Prominent, unavoidable booking link with a visible discount for booking direct vs. OTA ("Book direct. Best rate guaranteed.")
- ➔ **Crystal-clear policies:** Dedicated policies page addressing parking, deposits, check-in/out, and cancellation — the exact sources of contention in current reviews. No more surprises.
- ➔ **SEO foundation:** Proper on-page structure, fast load times, mobile-first, Core Web Vitals optimized
- ➔ **GEO-ready structure:** Hotel schema markup, FAQ pages with structured Q&A (feeds directly into Google AI Overviews and ChatGPT citations), consistent NAP across every page
- ➔ **Design direction:** Fresh and minimal with beach-kitschy warmth — warm sand tones, ocean references, handwritten-feel accents. Feels like a place worth staying, not a booking engine.

04

Email Automation

SETUP + ONGOING

Three automated emails that do real work: reduce pre-arrival misunderstandings, make guests feel welcomed on arrival, and turn happy guests into reviewers at exactly the right moment.

- ➔ **Booking confirmation:** Personalized, warm, practical. Explicitly covers parking policy, deposit terms, and check-in process — the exact issues generating bad reviews today. Sets accurate expectations before guests arrive.
- ➔ **Day of arrival:** Welcome message with check-in details, local recommendations, and a reminder of direct booking perks for their next visit
- ➔ **Post-departure:** Thank you note with a direct ask for a Google, Booking.com, or TripAdvisor review — with a discount code for booking direct on their next stay. Sent 24 hours after checkout while the experience is fresh.

The post-departure email is the engine behind review volume growth. A consistent, well-timed ask to every guest — automated — is how you go from 5 reviews a month to 20+.

05

Content Engine

MONTHLY

Consistent social and blog content that keeps Ocean Lodge visible and alive online year-round — not just in season. Planned, written, and posted by us.

- ➔ **Social media (Instagram + Facebook):** 3 posts per week — mix of property photos, local OC content, guest spotlights, seasonal promotions, and direct booking reminders
- ➔ **Blog (2 posts/month):** SEO-targeted articles that answer real travel questions ("Best oceanfront hotels in Ocean City," "What to do in OC with kids," "Hotels near the Ocean City boardwalk") — drives organic search traffic and feeds AI search citations
- ➔ All content reviewed and approved by you before publishing

06

Google & Instagram Ad Campaign

MONTHLY

A managed ad campaign running through the full summer season — the period where every dollar of visibility translates directly to bookings.

- ➔ **Google Search Ads:** Target high-intent searches ("hotels Ocean City MD," "ocean city boardwalk hotels," "ocean city vacation rentals") and capture travelers actively looking to book
- ➔ **Instagram / Meta Ads:** Visual campaigns using professional photography — retargeting website visitors and reaching new audiences in feeder markets (DC, Philadelphia, Baltimore, Pittsburgh)
- ➔ Monthly reporting: impressions, clicks, booking conversions, cost per acquisition
- ➔ Campaign creative produced by us; strategy adjusted monthly based on performance data

Ad spend is separate from the management fee and billed directly to your account. We recommend \$600–1,000/month during peak season

(May–September). We manage the budget allocation, targeting, and optimization.

07

Monthly Performance Reports

MONTHLY

Every month, a clear picture of where you stand and what's moving.

- Review volume + star rating trend (Google, TripAdvisor, Booking.com, Expedia)
- Competitive benchmarking vs. 3 comparable OC properties
- Website traffic, direct booking conversions, and booking source breakdown
- Email sequence performance (open rates, click rates, review conversion)
- Social reach and engagement
- Ad campaign performance: spend, impressions, bookings attributed
- Recommended focus areas for the coming month

[03]

DIVISION OF LABOR

BAYSIDE AI HANDLES

Draft + post all review responses

Google Business Profile setup + ongoing management

Professional photo shoot coordination

Website design, development + maintenance

Email sequence writing + automation setup

Social content writing + scheduling

Blog writing + publishing

Ad campaign setup, management + creative

Monthly performance reports

OCEAN LODGE TEAM HANDLES

Approve review responses before they go live

Decision on parking + deposit policies

Approve website content before launch

Provide access to booking system for email integration

Place QR review cards at the front desk

Deliver staff review request script to your team

Approve social and blog content before publishing

Ad spend billed to your account directly

Act on operational complaint digest (rooms, maintenance)

Front desk review request system (QR, script, email)

Important: We manage everything digital — reviews, visibility, content, ads. We can't fix the room if the AC breaks. The fastest path to a stronger reputation is our work combined with operational improvements. The monthly complaint digest we provide is your team's signal for where to focus on the ground.

ONE-TIME SETUP FEE

\$6,500

Billed at project kickoff

- ✓ Google Business Profile overhaul + 1-year review response backlog
- ✓ Professional photography session + asset library
- ✓ New website design + development
- ✓ SEO foundation + hotel schema + GEO structure
- ✓ Email automation setup (3 sequences)
- ✓ Front desk review request system
- ✓ Ad campaign setup + first creative set

MONTHLY RETAINER

\$2,000

Per month · No long-term contract

- ✓ Ongoing review management + responses
- ✓ GBP monitoring + optimization
- ✓ Website maintenance + content updates
- ✓ Email automation management
- ✓ Social content (3x/week, Instagram + Facebook)
- ✓ Blog posts (2/month)
- ✓ Google + Instagram ad management
- ✓ Monthly performance report

Ad spend (billed to your account directly)

\$600-1,000 / mo recommended

Contract length

Month-to-month

Cancellation

30 days notice

No long-term commitment required. The setup fee covers all the one-time build work. After that, you're on a rolling monthly retainer you can adjust or cancel with 30 days notice. The first month of the retainer includes the onboarding sprint — GBP live, review backlog done, front desk system deployed.

[05]

TIMELINE

WEEK 1

Review response drafts in your inbox · Complaint digest to ops team

Photo shoot scheduled · Website kickoff call

WEEK 2

Parking + policy decision made · Google responses begin going live

GBP photo upload begins after shoot · Front desk QR system live

WEEK 3-4

Website design mockups presented for approval

Email sequences drafted · Social content calendar built

MONTH 2

New website live · Email automation active · Content engine running

First monthly report · Ad campaigns launched

MONTH 3

Review velocity building · Rating trending upward

Blog content live and indexing · GEO structure taking shape

SUMMER 2026

Full campaign running · All channels active for peak season

Ads at full budget · Social and blog driving organic discovery

12 MONTHS

Sustainable review engine · Stronger search and AI visibility

Direct booking share growing · Ocean Lodge brand standing on its own

[NEXT STEP]

Ready to move forward?

Review this plan with your team. We're happy to walk through any section, adjust scope, or answer questions before you sign off.

Once approved, we kick off in Week 1.

APPROVE THIS PLAN →

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